TOGETHER , WE RISE

Learning from Our Past:
A Forward Vision for Special Education Services in Portland Public Schools

February 18, 2025

OUR WHY

Our mission is to **educate all children to their highest potential** to be productive, respectful, self-reliant, and responsible citizens who value the richness of diversity.

PPS REIMAGINED

Preparing Our Students to Lead Change and Improve the World

- Educational System Shifts
- Educator Essentials
- Graduate Portrait

FORWARD TOGETHER

Strategic Plan for Racial Equity, Inclusion, and Excellence

- Racial Equity & Social Justice
- Inclusive & Differentiated Learning
- Professional Excellence & Support
- Embracing Change

BOARD OF EDUCATION GOALS

Eliminate Opportunity and Outcome Gaps

- Third Grade Reading
- Fifth Grade Math
- Eighth Grade Readiness
- High School Graduation

Special Education in Portland Public Schools believes that all students belong to the schools communities of which they are a part.

PPS Strategic Goals

- Establish Systems and Structures for Inclusion
- Promote an Inclusive Mindset
- Build the Advocacy Power of Students and Families of Students with Disabilities
- Reimagine Relationships and a Sense of Belonging



Special Education Priorities

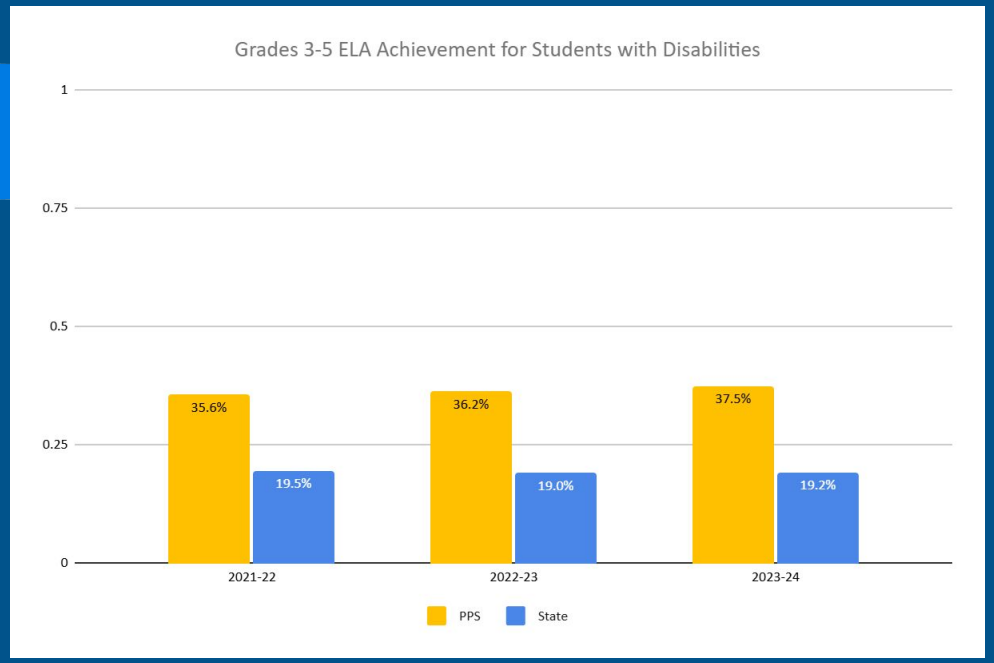
Community Connection/Engagement	Inclusion and Belonging	Program Development
• Community Conversation with Roots of Inclusion • Special Education Family Advisory Committee	• Community Focused Belonging and Engagement Activities • Neighborhood School Model • Listening Sessions	• Special Education Staff Steering Committee • Special Education Administrator Advisory • Special Education • Professional Learning integrated in Leadership • Systems of Professional • Learning on IEP and Program Development.

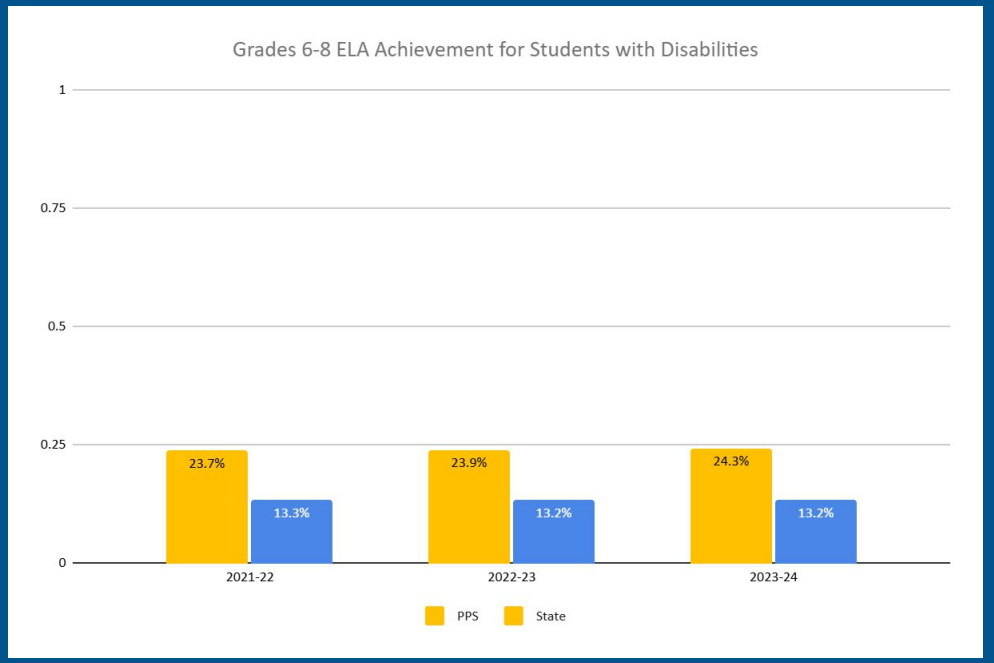
Representation

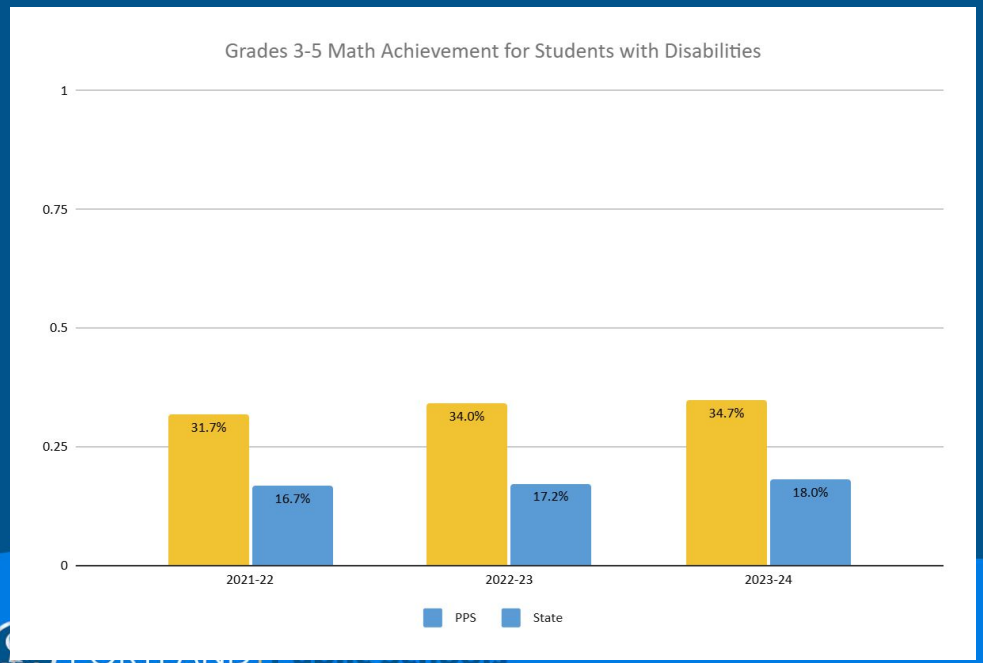
	2018-19	2019-20	2020-21	2021-22	2022-23	2023-24	2024-25
Special Education Identification	7379	7707	7136	7006	7362	7450	7624
District Enrollment	49550	49478	47314	45497	45456	44819	44086
Representation	14.8%	15.5%	15.1%	15.3%	16.2%	16.6%	17.2%

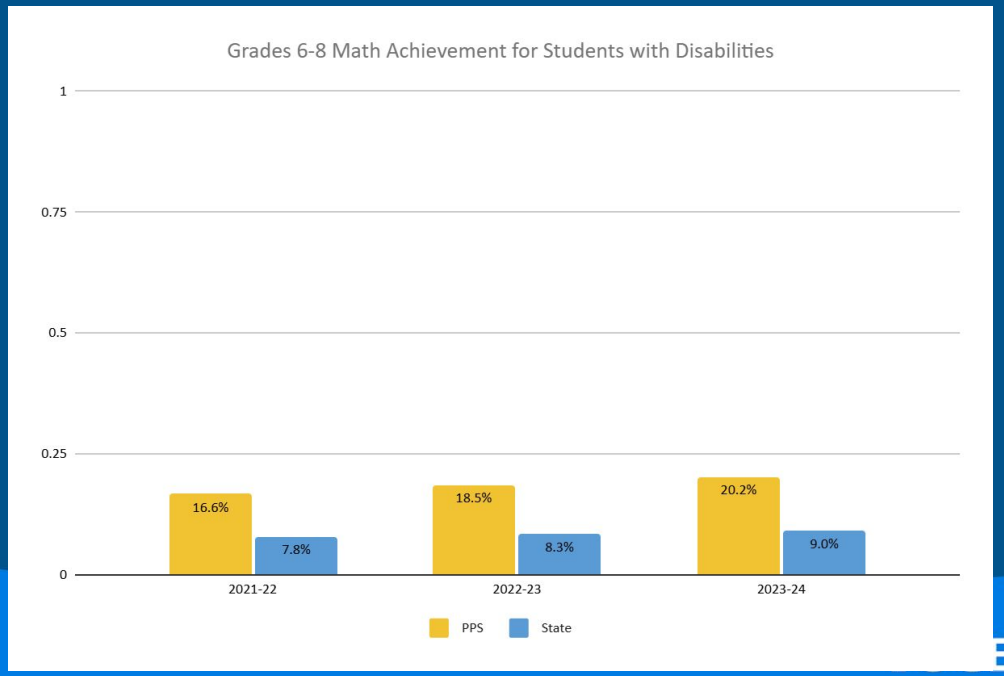
	2024-25	2023-24	2022-2023	2021-22
Autism Spectrum Disorder	1108	994	916	895
Speech/Language Impairment	1976	1944	1846	1736
Emotional Behavior Disability	397	387	377	416
Intellectually Disabled	167	168	172	197
Other Health Impairment	1622	1610	1613	1617
Specific Learning Disability	1693	1739	1620	1696
Other	428	408	372	245

2024/25 Total Students with IEP	**%**
American Indian / Alaskan Native	.9
Asian	3.5
Black / African American	11
Hispanic	19.7
Native Hawaiian / Other Pacific Islander	.4
Two or More	12.6
White	51.5

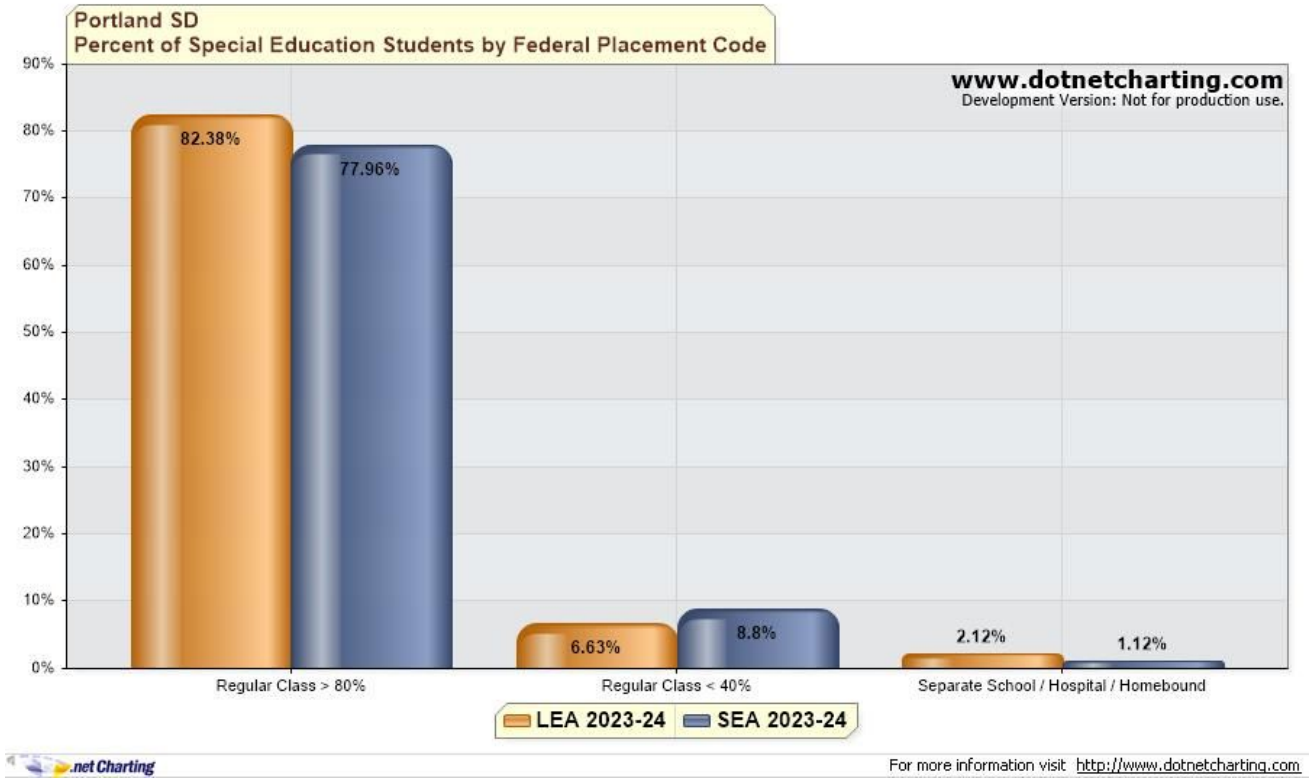

Grades 3-5 ELA Achievement for Students with Disabilities
1
0.75
0.5
0.25
0
35.6%
19.5%
36.2%
19.0%
37.5%
19.2%
2021-22
2022-23
2023-24
PPS
State


Grades 6-8 ELA Achievement for Students with Disabilities
1
0.75
0.5
0.25
0
23.7%
13.3%
23.9%
13.2%
24.3%
13.2%
2021-22
2022-23
2023-24
PPS
State


Grades 3-5 Math Achievement for Students with Disabilities
1
0.75
0.5
0.25
0
31.7%
16.7%
34.0%
17.2%
34.7%
18.0%
2021-22
2022-23
2023-24
PPS
State


Grades 6-8 Math Achievement for Students with Disabilities
1
0.75
0.5
0.25
0
16.6%
7.8%
18.5%
8.3%
20.2%
9.0%
2021-22
2022-23
2023-24
PPS
State

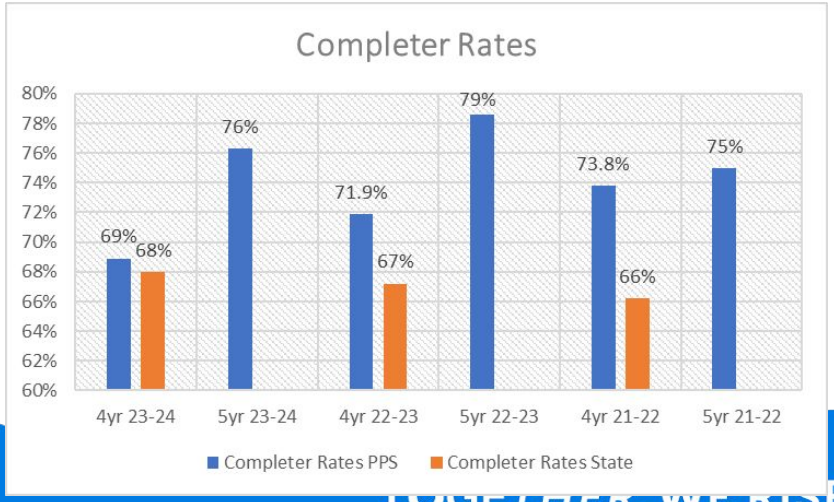
Inclusion and Belonging



Least Restrictive Environment

Student Engagement and Belonging - Successful Schools Survey -

2024-25 Results	Student Sense of Belonging	Student Engagement
K-5 Grade Band Average	+3	+6
Neighborhood Schools Average	+4	+6



What We Learned...

K5/K8 -Listening Session - Themes as of 2/4/25

- Staffing Needs
- Neighborhood Model Implementation Challenges
- Student Needs
- Communication and Collaboration
- Resource Limitations
- Training and Professional Development Gaps
- Administrative Strain
- Systemic Inconsistencies

How is Special Education Funded In Oregon?

Weighted Average Daily Membership (ADM-W) for a Student that Receives Special Education Services - 11% Cap and the limit on the High Cost Disability Fund

17% of Students in PPS receive Special Education Services.

Federal Funding

Student Investment Account

Current Service Level Means PPS is Underfunded to address the needs of our students with Disabilities

Special Education Expenditures

	2021-22	2022-23	2023-24	2024-25
Personnel (Instructional and Support Services)	$116,826,294	$120,971,133	$128,942,735	$54,205,960
Instructional (Non-Personnel)	$2,724,068	$4,091,847	$4,251,254	$860,941
Support Services (Non-Personnel)	$5,616,694	$5,543,263	$5,247,284	$1,950,838
Extended School Year	$305,044	$911,307	$405,929	$466,815
Transportation	$15,029,240	$21,129,819	$23,371,099	$8,279,570
High Cost Programming	$22,833,346.00	$ 24,303,984.00	$ 17,000,000.00	-

	2021-22	2022-23	2023-24
Total Special Education	$140,501,340	$152,647,369	$162,218,301

Special Education Revenue

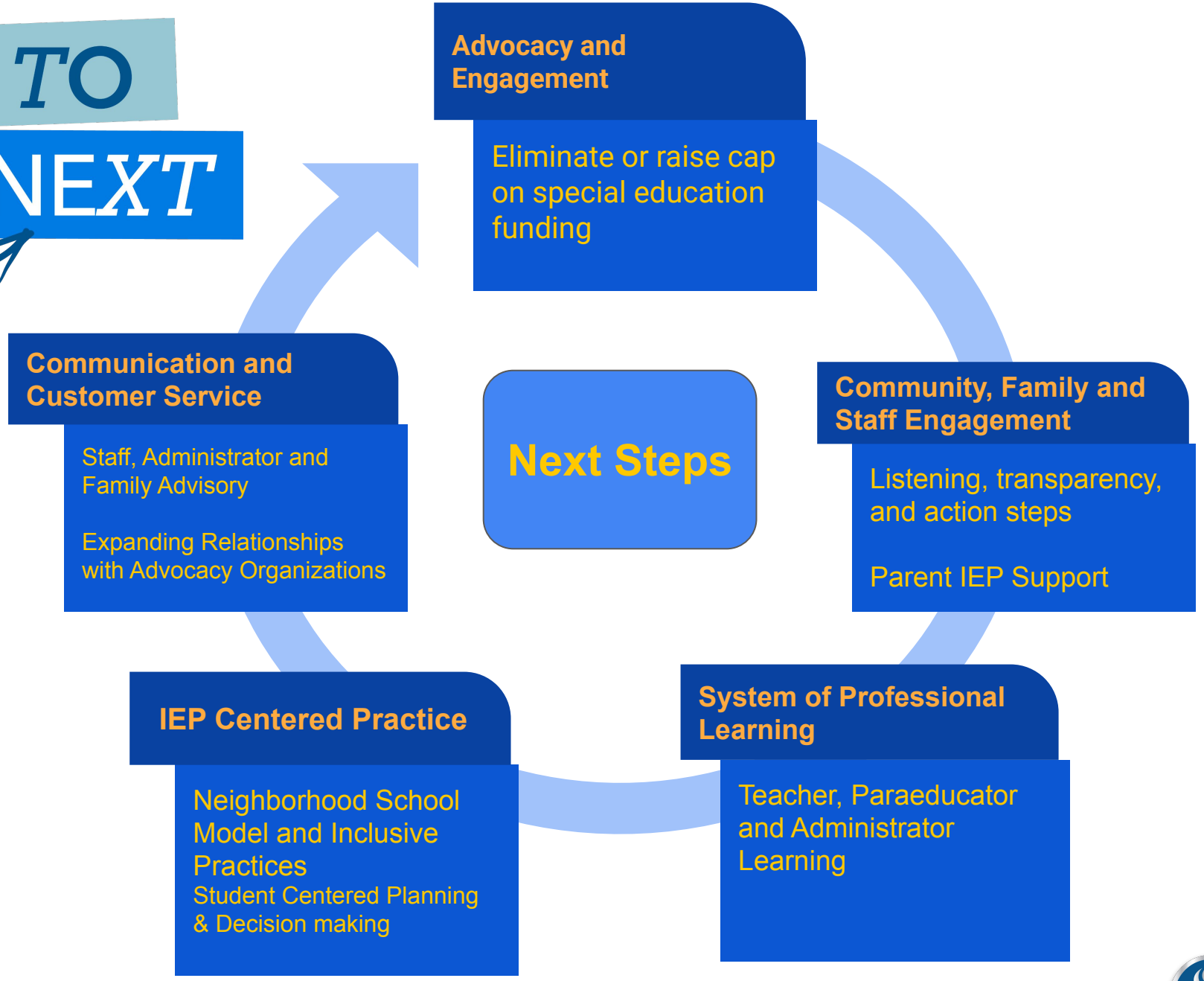
	2021-22	2022-23	2023-24	2024-25
Federal	$8,598,882	$8,969,445	$9,833,992	$8,937,186
State Special Education ADM-W Funding Allocation	**$56,347,415.00**	**$59,440,839.00**	**$59,627,555.00**	**$65,490,698.00**
Student Investment Account Supplement	$1,062,845	$1,200,000	$1,200,032	$3,274,369
High Cost Disability	(1018) $10,416,198	(1126) $9,968,880	(1127) $8,401,473	-
ESSER	-	$4,228,059	$7,060,629	-
Total	$75,362,495	$78,379,164	$77,863,020	TBD
Total with ADMr included			$143,899,682	
ADM-W W/O 11% Cap	$68,714,960.00	$73,082,832.00	$76,070,462.00	$83,409,326.00

Special Education Building Staffing

	2021-22	2022-23	2023-24	2024-25
Special Education Teacher FTE	258	261.5	266.5	266.3
SLP FTE	98.4	95	82.8	85.6
School Psychologist FTE	55	55.2	61.8	66.8
OT/PT FTE	28	25.75	26.9	25.9

	2021-22	2022-23	2023-24	2024-25
Paraeducator FTE (K-12)	429.23	446.18	463	465.85

WHAT TO EXPECT NEXT



TOGETHER, WE RISE

State Advocacy

Feb. 26th Special Education Advocacy Day

State Advocacy Toolkit

Get involved and help Oregon students achieve their highest potential!

- → Legislative Engagement
- → External Engagement
- → Templates and Scripts

Questions?

